

Chicago Tribune



QUESTIONS? CALL 1-800-TRIBUNE

SATURDAY, SEPTEMBER 6, 2025

BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

TRUMP'S CHICAGO THREAT

ICE officials ‘hiding’ from senators



Activists sing “We Shall Overcome” outside an Immigration and Customs Enforcement facility in Broadview on Friday. DOMINIC DI PALERMO/TRIBUNE

Durbin, Duckworth turned away at naval station in attempt to gather information about takeover

By Rebecca Johnson, Olivia Olander, Rick Pearson and Steve Sadin
Chicago Tribune

Democratic U.S. Sens. Dick Durbin and Tammy Duckworth were turned away Friday from offices at Naval Station Great Lakes in North Chicago that are being used by the U.S. Department of Homeland Security as an operations hub for immigrant enforcement actions in Chicago. The senators, joined by local Democratic U.S. Rep. Brad Schnei-

der of Highland Park, met with Navy officials for about 90 minutes. But when they sought to meet with DHS and Immigration and Customs Enforcement officials, “The office was locked and no one was there,” Duckworth said. “They fled, and they’re hiding, and that is a clear indication of how secretive they want to be on this effort.” Durbin, Duckworth and Schneider were told by Navy officials that DHS will have office space but will not have barracks for people

Turn to ICE, Page 4

CHICAGOLAND City in the dark on ICE plans

Police Superintendent Larry Snelling said he still had no information Friday afternoon about a promised sweeping federal immigration crackdown that could potentially bring the National Guard to Chicago streets. **Page 4**

■ 10-foot-high fencing surrounding the Dirksen U.S. Courthouse is one of the first visible signs of a potential incursion. **Page 3**

With hidden evidence on their minds, unusual dive team takes to the Chicago River



METAL DETECTORS

By Caroline Kubzansky | Chicago Tribune

Darick Langos toppled backward into the Chicago River and came up grinning. He tapped his head twice and splashed a little water into his scuba mask. Then he called out to the crew still aboard the boat bobbing in the water just south of the Cermak Road bridge. “Love you! Bye,” he yelled. With a whoosh, he sank down to the riverbed to peer through the murky green. But instead of collecting samples of water or aquatic life, Langos was searching for license plates and brand emblems from “a pile of cars” on the river floor. The self-described Chaos Divers have been boating up and down the Chicago River for much of the week, canvassing for evidence to help crack a handful of long-cold missing persons cases.

The group, which shares its exploits on social media, has been crisscrossing the country since late June to dive lakes and rivers where they believe people and their cars may be at the bottom. Earlier this year, they helped identify and retrieve from the Fox River a Toyota Celica belonging to Karen Schepers, which had been missing — along with Schepers herself — since 1983. The group, running largely off of YouTube subscriber revenue and donations, said it’s found 20 people over about four years of diving, including five Illinoisans. Thursday afternoon, Langos resurfaced from his first 20-foot dive after about eight minutes, holding a rusted steering wheel over his head. He clambered back

onto the 26-foot powerboat and added it to a stack of rusted, bent license plates taken from nearly 100 cars the group has located at the bottom of the river. Maverick, the group’s gray Labradoodle, scurried back through the boat’s cockpit. Langos gave a quick rundown of what he’d seen: a 1996 Ford Explorer, “all the windows busted out, nobody inside of it, on its wheels.” The fact that the car was upright was of some note, the group’s general manager Lindsay Bussick said. “Most vehicles that we find are upside down,” Bussick said. “And so the car will go in the water, the air in the tires will flip it upside down, and the weight of the engine will pull it down.”

Turn to Divers, Page 2

Darick Langos, a support diver for the Chaos Divers, holds a license plate from a sunken car in the Chicago River near Cermak Road on Thursday. The Chaos Divers team has been searching the Chicago River for old cars in order to help solve cold cases. EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

BRONZEVILLE

With city under microscope, anti-violence group responds to shootings

By Tess Kenny and Sam Charles
Chicago Tribune

Within the span of 26 hours last weekend, two mass shootings in Bronzeville injured 12 people — including critically wounding a 17-year-old — both within blocks of one another and minutes away

from the Chicago Police Department’s headquarters. But while a federal crime crackdown looms over the city, a possible move only bolstered by the violent Labor Day weekend, local street outreach workers remain focused on their efforts to clamp down on the violence in the neighborhood.

“I can tell you we’re going to continue to do our job,” said Bamani Obadele, community engagement director for Acclivus, Inc., a community organization that provides violence intervention programs to help people in Chicago’s most vulnerable neighborhoods. “We’re not taking any days off”

City violence data reviewed by the Tribune found that, after last weekend, 10 mass shootings have occurred in Bronzeville since the start of 2019. Cook County court records indicate charges have not been filed in any. On Saturday night, seven people were injured after an unknown assailant drove by and opened fire

on a crowd standing outside on the 3500 block of South State Street, near where the former Stateway Gardens public housing complex stood until the early 2000s. Obadale said that according to initial accounts from community residents and Acclivus outreach

Turn to Violence, Page 2

